MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CUTTER, CABLE, HAND OPERATED, WITH GROPING HOOK GUIDE

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers one type and size hand-operated cable cutter with a groping hook guide, having a capacity for cutting 3/8-inch diameter solid steel wire.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

QQ-W-461	-	Wire, Steel, Carbon (Round, Bare and Coated).
PPP-P-40	-	Packaging and Packing of Hand Tools.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

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National Bureau of Standards

Handbook H-28 - Screw Thread Standards for Federal Services

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington, D.C. 20402.)

American Society For Testing and Materials

ASTM Standard D-395; Compression Set of Vulcanized Rubber.
ASTM Standard D-635; Method of Test for Flammability for Rigid Plastic Over 0.050 Inches in Thickness.
ASTM Standard D-2240; Indentation Hardness of Rubber and Plastics by Means of a Durometer.
ASTM Standard E18-68; Method for Testing for Rockwell Hardness and Rockwell Superficial Hardness of Metallic Material.

(Copies of ASTM Standards may be obtained from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

* 3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.2), the supplier shall furnish a sample for first article inspection and approval (see 4.2, and 6.3).

* 3.2 Material. The materials shall be of the quality normally used in commercial practice provided that the cable cutters conform to the requirements of this specification.

* 3.3 Construction and design. The cutter shall be similar, but not necessarily restricted to the design of the cutter shown in figures 1 and 2, and shall consist essentially of a cutting head, intermediate links between the handles and jaws, and handles. The overall length of the cutter shall be 20-1/2 inches, plus or minus 1/2 inch, and the weight shall be no more than 5 pounds, 2 ounces. All screw threads on the cutter shall be in accordance with National Bureau of Standards Handbook H-28. The cutters shall be capable of cutting 3/8-inch diameter solid steel wire conforming to 1015, 1018 or 1020, finish 1, annealed in process of QQ-W-461 under a load of not more than 150 pounds with no loosening of components or evidence of fractures, breakage, marring of jaw edges and no deviation of the initial spacing between jaw cutting edges in excess of 0.010 inch when tested as specified in 4.4.1 (1).

* 3.3.1 Cutting head. The cutting head shall consist of a pair of jaws, two jaw straps, two strap bolts and a groping hook guide.

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* 3.3.1.1 Jaws. The jaws shall be made of commercial grade alloy tool steel, smoothly finished and free from pits and cracks. The thickness of each jaw shall be not less than 0.300 inch. The difference in thickness of each jaw at any two points shall not exceed 0.004 inch. The difference in the average thickness of the two mating jaws shall not exceed 0.005 inch. Pivotal means shall be provided on the jaws for equalizing jaw movement and preventing lateral motion of the jaws. The two jaws shall be mounted with no visible sideplay due to excessive clearance between jaws and side bearing surfaces or misalignment of jaw edges. The jaws shall be removable to allow for sharpening of the cutting edges or replacement. Cutting edges of the jaw shall be center cut, similar to figure 1. The hardness of the jaws on the bevel, 1/8-inch from the cutting edges, shall be Rockwell C 58-62 when tested as specified in 4.4.2.1.

3.3.1.2 Jaw straps. The jaw straps shall be made of medium carbon steel, heat treated to a hardness of Rockwell C 35-45 when tested as specified in 4.4.2.2. The straps shall be either the integral bolt type or the threaded type. When of the integral bolt type, the jaw bolts shall be pressed into one strap and secured to prevent rotation of the bolts and each of the bolts shall be provided with locknuts for securing the jaws. If of the threaded type, the strap on the base plane of the jaws shall be threaded to properly accommodate the strap bolts for securing the jaws. Lock plates, lock-washers or other positive means shall be provided to prevent the bolts from becoming loose or rotating. The protruding portion of the bolts shall be held to a minimum to prevent interference in confined areas (see 3.3.4).

3.3.1.3 Groping hook guide. The groping hook guide shall be no less than 3/32 inches thick, shall consist of a double hook similar to figure 1, and shall be ruggedly constructed of high grade malleable-iron casting, steel casting, steel stamping, or steel forging. The hook guide shall be attached to the cutting head so that the double hook shall be capable of groping for and guiding a wire or cable between the cutter jaws to cut. The double hook shall extend 1-7/8 inches, plus or minus 1/8 inch beyond the cutting head. The hook guide shall withstand a free drop of 3 feet on a hard surface, with no binding of the jaws or no visible evidence of deformation or fractures when tested as specified in 4.4.3.

* 3.3.2 Intermediate links. The cutter shall have intermediate links that, in combination with the handles and jaws, shall provide the cutter with compound movement and mechanical advantage for cutting wire. The intermediate links shall be high-grade malleable-iron castings, steel castings, or steel forgings. The intermediate link shall be a separate link or integral with the handle and shall be provided with means for adjustment of the jaws.

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* 3.3.2.1 Jaw adjustment. The jaw adjustment shall consist of a 1/4-20 minimum size, hardened bolt and lock nut, optional with the manufacturer. The jaw adjustment shall be capable of adjusting the spacing between the holes of the tail end of the jaws, a minimum of 1/4 inch.

* 3.3.3 Handles. The cutter handles shall be high-grade malleable-iron-castings, steel castings, steel forgings or steel tubing. When steel tubing is used, the tubing shall be firmly attached to preclude loosening during hard usage. The handles shall have a covering of insulation for the protection of the operator against high voltages, and bumpers or stops to prevent the handles from being closed beyond the effective cutting point and pinching the hand of the operator. The handles shall be capable of withstanding a force of 175 pounds on each handle with no permanent deformation in excess of 3/32 inch between the handles when tested as specified in 4.4.1 (2).

* 3.3.3.1 Insulation. The insulation of the handle shall be applied on the handle to obtain thorough adhesion, a smooth surface and no distortion. Insulation on cutter handles, except tubular handles, shall cover the handle with a minimum of 8 inches of insulation and up to 1 inch of the bumpers plus or minus 1/8 inch. Insulation on tubular handles shall cover the handle up to within 1/2 inch from the jaw end of the tubing and shall have a hand guard projection located 8 inches plus or minus 1/4 inch from the bottom end of the handle to the guard edge nearest the jaw end. The insulation shall have a smooth and hard surface with no distortion pinholes, blisters, cuts, waviness or similar imperfections. The handle insulation shall be black and shall have:

(1) A dielectric strength to withstand a 14,000 volt RMS, 60 Hertz AC potential for 1 minute, with no leakage or passage of current in excess of 500 microamperes total for both cutter handles when tested as specified in 4.4.4. The insulation shall show no abnormal distortion or blistering after testing in accordance with 4.4.4.

(2) Resistance to moisture absorption so that after immersion in water, the insulation shall withstand a 7,000 volt RMS, 60 Hertz, AC potential with no flash over (surface discharge), spark over (air discharge), or breakdown (puncture discharge) when tested as specified in 4.4.5

(3) Resistance to impact so that the insulation of the handles shall withstand the blow of a sharp edged object and also comply with the distortion, blistering dielectric strength requirements in (1) above when tested as specified in 4.4.6.

(4) Resistance to oil, heat, acid and alkali with no deterioration of the handle insulation, such as blistering, swelling, peeling, becoming spongy or being dissolved when tested as specified in 4.4.7, 4.4.8 and 4.4.9, as applicable.

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(5) Resistance to flaming, as self-extinguishing or non-burning of the insulation material when tested as specified in 4.4.10.

* 3.3.3.2 Bumper. The bumpers on the cutter handles, except tubular handles, shall be rubber. The bumpers on the tubular handles shall be solid and integral with the handle. When rubber bumpers are used, they shall have a durometer hardness of Shore A 50 to 75 and shall withstand compression to 50 percent of the initial length of the bumper for 48 hrs. at 80°F. ± 10°F with no cracking, splitting, or permanent set of the rubber in excess of 5 percent when tested as specified in 4.4.11. The outer surface of the rubber bumpers shall be protected with steel washers or rivet heads equal to a minimum of 80 percent of the diameter of the rubber when not compressed.

* 3.3.4 Bolts. The bolts of the cutter shall be made of steel, hardened to Rockwell C 30-40, or case hardened to 80-90 on the Rockwell 15-N scale (superficial) when tested as specified in 4.4.2.3. The threaded portion of the bolt shall not extend more than one full thread into the bolt bearing surface of the cutter part when threaded to receive the bolt. The bolts shall have locking means to prevent rotation or loosening of the bolt. When bolt and nut are used, the nut shall be of the prevailing torque locknut-type.

3.4 Finish. Prior to the application of finish, cutter surfaces shall be treated or cleaned to provide a smooth and adherent surface. The cutting head, including bolts, screws, nuts, washers, and lock plates, shall have a corrosion resistant, dense, oiled black phosphate finish. The exposed surfaces of the handle and intermediate links shall be finished with a dull black, baked enamel or lacquer coating. Finishes shall be smooth, adherent and in accordance with manufacturer's commercial practice.

* 3.5 Marking. The cutters shall be permanently and legible marked with the manufacturer's name or readily identifiable trademark and following notice:

"WARNING - 5000 VOLTS, MAX.".

3.6 Workmanship. The cutters shall be free from burrs, slivers, blowholes, porosity, nodules and shrinkage defects; components shall not be bent, fractured, broken, missing, or binding. The cutters shall be free of areas of no finish, and varnish or lacquer coating shall be free of sags, runs, wrinkles, embedded foreign matter or tackiness.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

* 4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise

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specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

* 4.2 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be examined in accordance with table I, dimensions specified, and tested in accordance with 4.4.1 through 4.4.11. The presence of any defects, or failure to pass any test, shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

* 4.3 Inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

* 4.3.1 Component and material inspection. The supplier shall insure that all components and materials used are manufactured, examined and tested in accordance with referenced specifications, drawings and standards, unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.3.2 In-process inspection.

* 4.3.2.1 Process examination. Examination shall be made of the uncoated cutter to determine that metal surfaces, prior to application of finish, have been cleaned and oxide-scale removed. Whenever any nonconformance is noted correction shall be made to the process and all items processed.

* 4.3.2.2 Intermediate testing. Each pair of insulated cutter handles, joined together prior to assembly of the cutter, shall be tested in accordance with 4.4.4. Failure to pass the test shall be cause for rejection of the handles.

* 4.3.3 End item inspection. The lot shall consist of all cable cutters offered for inspection at one time.

* 4.3.3.1 Visual examination. Cable cutters shall be examined for the defects in table I. The inspection level shall be level II with an acceptable quality level of 2.5 for major defects and 6.5 for total defects, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE I. Classification of defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Design and construction	Jaws with sideplay or not in alignment.	X	
	Jaw strap bolts rotate.	X	

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TABLE I. Classification of defects (cont'd)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Design and construction (cont'd)	Groping hook guide not in alignment guiding cable between jaws for cutting.	X	
	Tubular handle not firmly attached.	X	
	Handle insulation not thoroughly adhering, not smooth or distorted.	X	
	Bumpers do not prevent handles from closing beyond effective cutting point or pinching of operator's hands.	X	
	Rubber bumper washers or rivet heads not finished with phosphated finish.	X	
	Bolt threads extending more than one thread in bearing surface of cutter part.		X
Finish	Not as specified.	X	
	Not smooth or adherent.	X	
Marking	Missing, illegible or otherwise incorrect.		X
Workmanship	Cutter not free from burrs, slivers, blowholes, porosity, nodules or shrinkage defects.	X	
	Cutter not free of areas of no finish.		X
	Varnish or lacquer coating not free of sags, runs, wrinkles, imbedded foreign matter or tackiness.		X
	Component bent, fractured, broken, missing, or binding.	X	

* 4.3.3.2 Dimensional and weight examination. The cutters shall be examined for compliance with weight and dimensions specified. Any weight and dimension not within tolerance shall constitute a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an acceptable quality level of 4.0, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

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* 4.3.3.3 End item testing. Each sample unit shall be tested as specified in 4.4.1 thru 4.4.11. Failure of any test shall be a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an acceptable quality level of 1.5 defects, expressed in defects per hundred units. The sample unit shall consist of 5 cutters. Each cutter shall be tested in accordance with the testing sequence in table II as follows:

(1) Cutter No. 1 - sequence 1 thru 11.
(2) Cutter No. 2 - sequence 12.
(3) Cutter No. 3 - sequence 13.
(4) Cutter No. 4 - sequence 14.
(5) Cutter No. 5 - sequence 15.

4.3.4 Test methods. The test schedule shall be in accordance with table II.

TABLE II. Test schedule

Testing sequence	First article	Quality conformance	Test	Test paragraph	Requirement paragraph
1	X	X	Cutting	4.4.1 (1)	3.3
2	X	X	Deformation	4.4.1 (2)	3.3.3
3	X	X	Jaw Hardness	4.4.2.1	3.3.1.1
4	X	X	Strap Hardness	4.4.2.2	3.3.1.2
5	X	X	Bolt Hardness	4.4.2.3	3.3.4
6	X	X	Drop	4.4.3	3.3.1.3
7	X	X	Bumper Hardness	4.4.11 (1)	3.3.3.2 (1)
8	X	X	Bumper Compressibility	4.4.11 (2)	3.3.3.2 (2)
9	X	X	Impact	4.4.6	3.3.3.1 (3)
10	X	X	Dielectric	4.4.4	3.3.3.1 (1)
11	X	X	Absorption	4.4.5	3.3.3.1 (2)
12	X	X	Oil and Heat	4.4.7	3.3.3.1 (4)
13	X	X	Acid	4.4.8	3.3.3.1 (4)
14	X	X	Alkali	4.4.9	3.3.3.1 (4)
15	X	X	Flaming	4.4.10	3.3.3.1 (5)

* 4.3.5 Certificate examination. Certificates of compliance, certified test reports, approval labels or listing marks for codes and standards, as applicable that are submitted as proof of compliance with specification requirements shall be examined and validated.

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* 4.3.6 Examination of preparation for delivery. Examination of preparation for delivery requirements shall be made in accordance with PPP-P-40.

4.4 Tests.

* 4.4.1 Cutting and handle deformation tests. With loads applied at a point 2 inches, plus or minus 1/8 inch from the end of each handle, the cutter shall be tested for cutting capability and permanent handle deformation as follows:

(1) The cutter shall make six cuts on the wire specified in 3.3 to settle the tool. The jaws shall be adjusted to provide an initial spacing of 0.005 inches between the cutting edges. An additional six cuts of the specified wire shall be made at a point 1/2 inch from the nose end of the jaws and the cutting loads shall be checked and cutters examined to determine compliance with the cutting requirements of 3.3. Any nonconformance shall constitute failure of this test.

(2) The distance between opposite points, marked and located at the extreme grip end of each handle, shall be measured with the bumpers barely making contact. With the jaws of the cutters restrained to prevent the bumpers from making contact, a 175-pound load shall be applied on each handle and released. The distance between the two opposite points previously measured shall be checked again with the bumpers barely making contact to determine compliance with the deformation requirements of 3.3.3. Any nonconformance shall constitute failure of this test.

4.4.2 Hardness tests. Hardness tests shall be in accordance with ASTM Standard E18-68. Hardness shall be based on the average of three determinations.

4.4.2.1 Jaw. Jaws shall be tested for hardness to determine compliance with the jaw hardness requirements of 3.3.1.1. Any nonconformance shall constitute failure of this test.

4.4.2.2 Jaw strap. Jaw straps shall be tested for hardness to determine compliance with 3.3.1.2. Any nonconformance shall constitute failure of this test.

4.4.2.3 Bolt. Bolts shall be tested for hardness to determine compliance with the hardness requirements of 3.3.4. Any nonconformance shall constitute failure of this test.

* 4.4.3 Groping hook guide drop test. The cutter shall be dropped from a height of 3 feet, plus or minus 1/16 inch, on a concrete floor with the hooks of the groping hook guide facing downward. This test shall be repeated three times to determine compliance with the hook guide drop requirements of 3.3.1.3. Any nonconformance shall constitute failure of this test.

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* 4.4.4 Dielectric test. Both insulated handles of the cutters shall be immersed in a 1 percent saline solution a distance of 2 to 2-1/2 inches from the jaw end edge of the hand guard projection of the handle insulation. At a rate of 3,000 volts per second, a 60 Hertz AC voltage shall be applied between the cutter jaws as one electrode, and the saline solution container as the other electrode, until a potential of 14,000 volts RMS is applied, held for 1 minute, and the current measured to determine compliance with the insulation, distortion or blistering and current leakage requirements of 3.3.3.1 (1). Any nonconformance shall constitute failure of this test.

* 4.4.5 Resistance to moisture absorption test. The insulation of the cutter handles shall be immersed in water for 1/2 hour, removed and wiped dry. Two metal foil electrodes with inside edges spaced 1 inch apart shall be placed on the surface of the handle insulation. With the same test equipment and procedure of applying voltage as in 4.4.4, a 7,000 volt, 60 Hertz AC potential shall be applied between the metal foil electrodes and held for 1 minute to determine compliance with the moisture absorption resistance requirements of 3.3.3.1 (2). Any nonconformance shall constitute failure of this test.

* 4.4.6 Resistance to impact test. The cutter shall be rigidly mounted and the insulation on one of the handles shall be subjected to one blow of 5-foot pounds of energy, imparted by means of an impact pendulum through a hardened steel cutting edge. The cutting edge shall be the foremost edge of a 90° wedge, 0.010 inch wide and 1 inch long. The blow shall be struck at right angles to the handle length. The insulation of the handle shall then be tested in accordance with 4.4.4 to determine compliance with the impact resistance requirements of 3.3.3.1 (3). Any nonconformance shall constitute failure of this test.

* 4.4.7 Resistance to oil and heat test. The insulation of the handle shall be soaked in S.A.E. (Society of Automotive Engineers) No. 30 oil, at 250°F. for 5 hours and examined to determine compliance with the oil and heat resistance requirements of 3.3.3.1 (4). Any nonconformance shall constitute failure of this test.

* 4.4.8 Resistance to acid. The insulation of the handle shall be soaked in a 20 percent sulfuric acid solution at 150°F., for 1 hour, rinsed thoroughly in distilled water and examined to determine compliance with the acid resistance requirements of 3.3.3.1 (4). Any nonconformance shall constitute failure of this test.

* 4.4.9 Resistance to alkali test. The insulation of the handle shall be soaked in a 40 percent sodium hydroxide solution at 150°F., for 1 hour rinsed thoroughly in distilled water, and examined to determine compliance with the alkali resistance requirements of 3.3.3.1 (4). Any nonconformance shall constitute failure of this test.

* 4.4.10 Resistance to flaming test. The insulation of handles shall be tested for flammability resistance in accordance with ASTM Standard D-635 to determine compliance with the resistance to flaming requirements of 3.3.3.1 (5). Any nonconformance shall constitute failure of this test.

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* 4.4.11 Rubber bumper test. The rubber bumpers on the handles shall be tested as follows:

(1) The rubber bumper shall be tested for hardness in accordance with ASTM Standard 676 to determine compliance with 3.3.3.2 (1). Any nonconformance shall constitute failure of this test.

(2) The rubber bumper shall be tested for compressibility in accordance with ASTM Standard D-395 to determine compliance with 3.3.3.2 (2). Any nonconformance shall constitute failure of this test.

* 5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Levels A, B, and C. Cutters shall be preserved, packaged, packed and marked for each level of protection in accordance with PPP-P-40 (see 6.2).

6. NOTES

* 6.1 Intended use. The cable cutter covered by the specification is intended for cutting electrically charged barbed wire entanglements and electrical transmission lines not exceeding 5,000 volts potential.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) When a first article is required (see 3.1).
(c) Selection of applicable level of preservation, packaging and packing (see 5.1).

* 6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of ASPR 7-104.55. The first article should be a preprodutction sample, initial production item, or other specific item described under the definition of a first article in the ASPR. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all procurement instruments regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.4 The margins of this specification have been marked with an asterisk (*) to indicate where changes (additions, deletions, modifications, corrections) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and suppliers are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire contents irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

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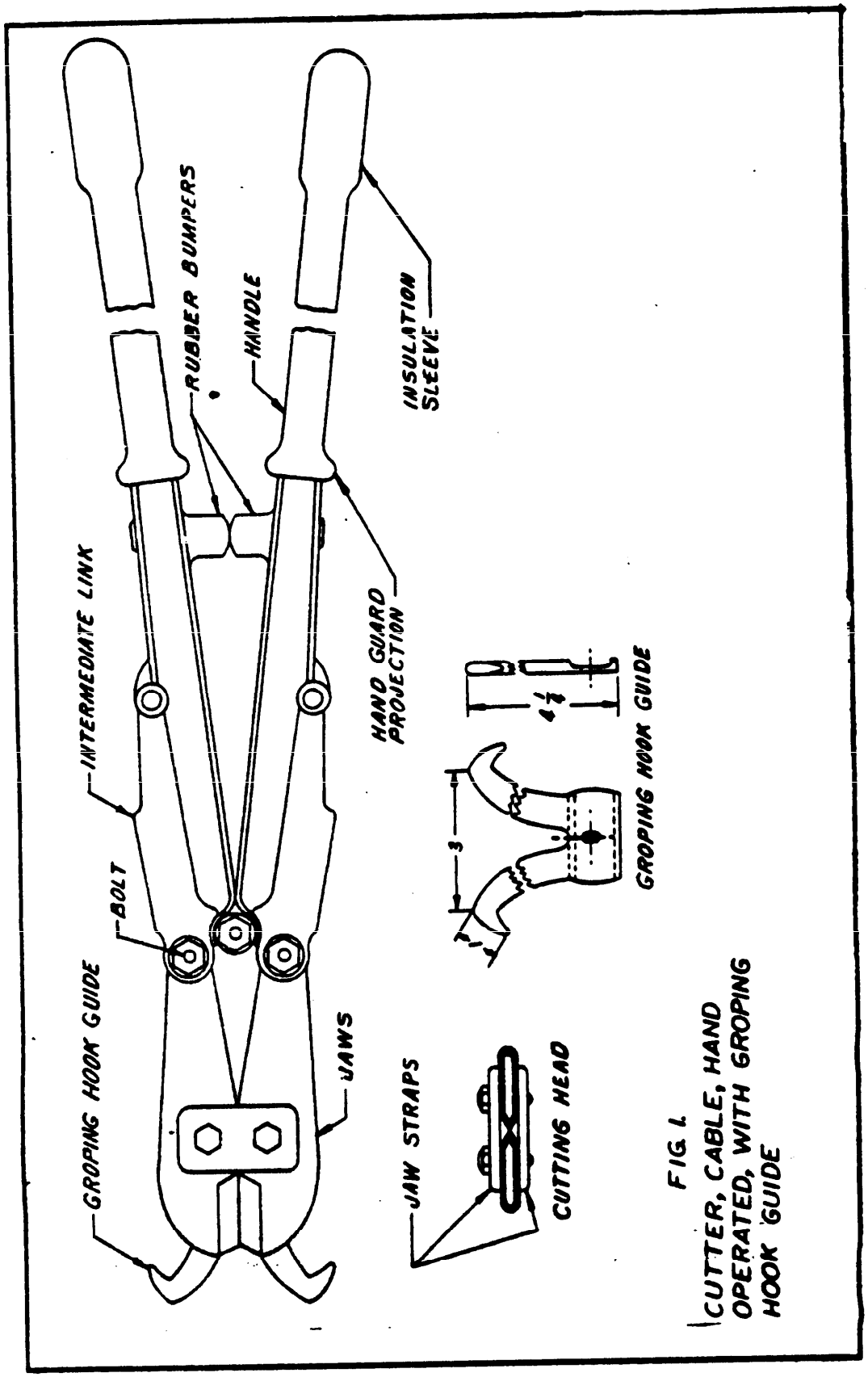
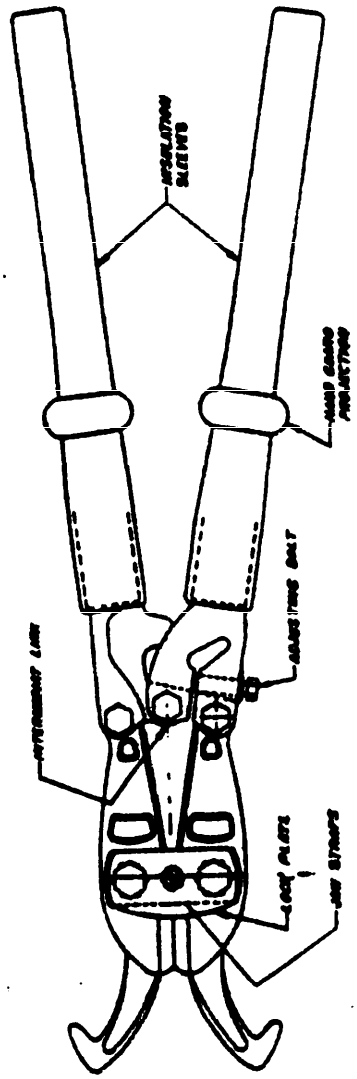


FIG. 1
CUTTER, CABLE, HAND OPERATED, WITH GROPING HOOK GUIDE

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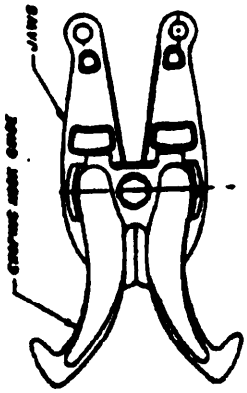


FIGURE 2
CUTTER, CABLE, HAND OPERATED

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SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

Form Approved
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INSTRUCTIONS: This sheet is to be filled out by personnel, either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments and suggestions submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or serve to amend contractual requirements.

SPECIFICATION
Cutter, Cable, Hand Operated With Groping Guide MIL-C-3958C

ORGANIZATION

CITY AND STATE

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A
☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

   B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?
   ☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity - Optional)*

DATE

DD, FORM 1 JAN 66 1426 REPLACES EDITION OF 1 OCT 64 WHICH MAY BE USED.

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